could touch on his own indictments. She is formally right, and such decisions are her domain. It may be regrettable under the circumstances.

Thursday, February 16

Today *Haaretz* gave an overview of what they know about Kohelet, the ultra-right libertarian organization that for some ten years now has been promoting a regime change in Israel in favor of extreme religious nationalism. Apparently they utilize some 150 researchers, coordinated by one Moshe Koppel, to feed their ideas to various ministers, Knesset members, and high officials. According to the article, Yariv Levin shared their ideas for years. In the past, Netanyahu blocked Levin; now, as it became convenient due to his own legal troubles, he supports him. Kohelet is apparently financed by some Jewish-American billionaires.

Kohelet, as described in that article, sounds a bit like Dan Brown's Opus Dei, in slightly less mysterious garb. It is hard to see, however, how the present Israeli government's push to destroy the freedom of the courts and promote a religiously controlled society fits with the quasi-anarchist doctrines of libertarians. In short, we haven't yet deciphered the ultimate secret codes of the message hidden behind our national catastrophe. Maybe it is merely wrapped inside Netanyahu's indictments. What a letdown!

Friday, February 17

It is a strange comfort, yet it is true: Israel has been on the brink of catastrophe several times and each time it pulled itself together and overcame the crisis. In 1948, when the Egyptian army advanced in the South, the Jordanian Arab Legion in the East, the Syrians in the North … or, on Yom Kippur 1973, when the Egyptians overwhelmed the Israeli defenses in the Sinai and the Syrians managed the same on the Golan. This